Techstream
Data Acquisition

Vehicle Control History, PCS Freeze Frame Data & camera images

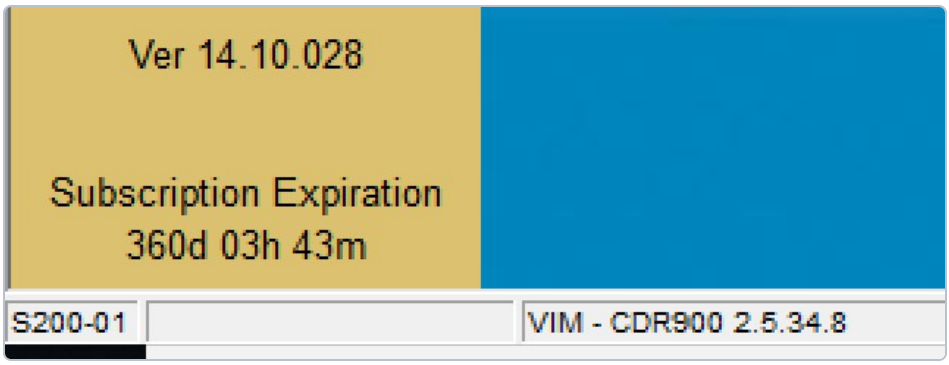
Field steps, at the vehicle · Rev. Sept 2026
Screens after B. Muir / Crash Data Specialists and E. Clarke / CHP MAIT

Before you start

- Confirm you have lawful authority. Some states require the owner's written consent.
- Confirm the TIS subscription is active — **Professional Diagnostics**, not Standard.
- Retrieve early. VCH records overwrite; every key cycle risks losing data.
- Have a booster battery. A read can take **1–90 minutes**.
- Photograph the vehicle, VIN plate, odometer and DLC. Note laptop clock vs. actual time.
- **Screen-capture every screen as you go.** They cannot be recreated later.

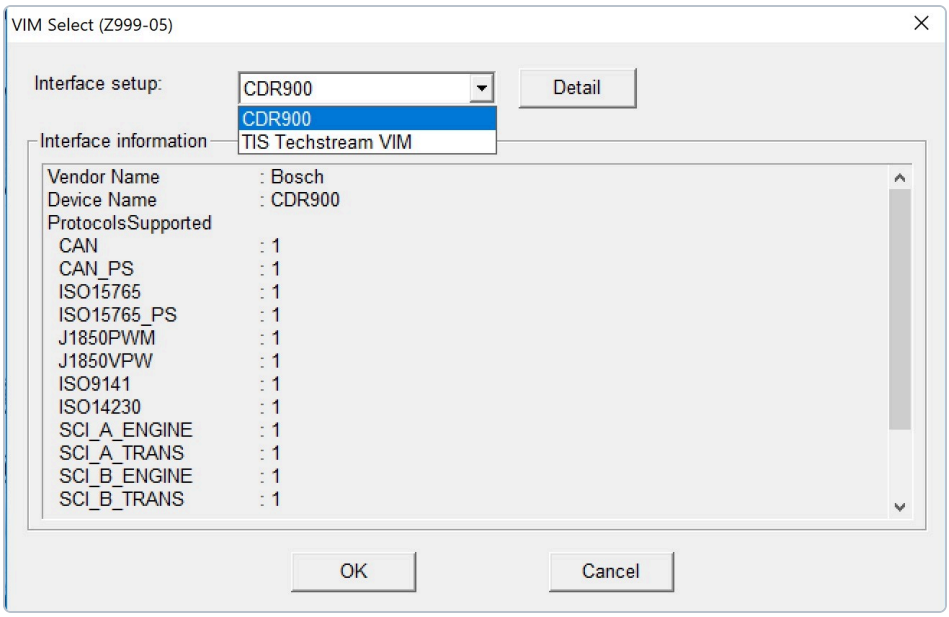
1 Check for **12 volts** at the battery. Turn the ignition **ON** — do not start the engine. Connect the VIM to the DLC and to the laptop.

2 Launch Techstream. **Capture the main screen** — software version, remaining subscription time (lower left) and the active VIM in the status bar.



Step 2 — lower-left corner of the main screen.

3 Click **Setup** → **VIM Select**. Choose your interface, click **OK**, and capture it.

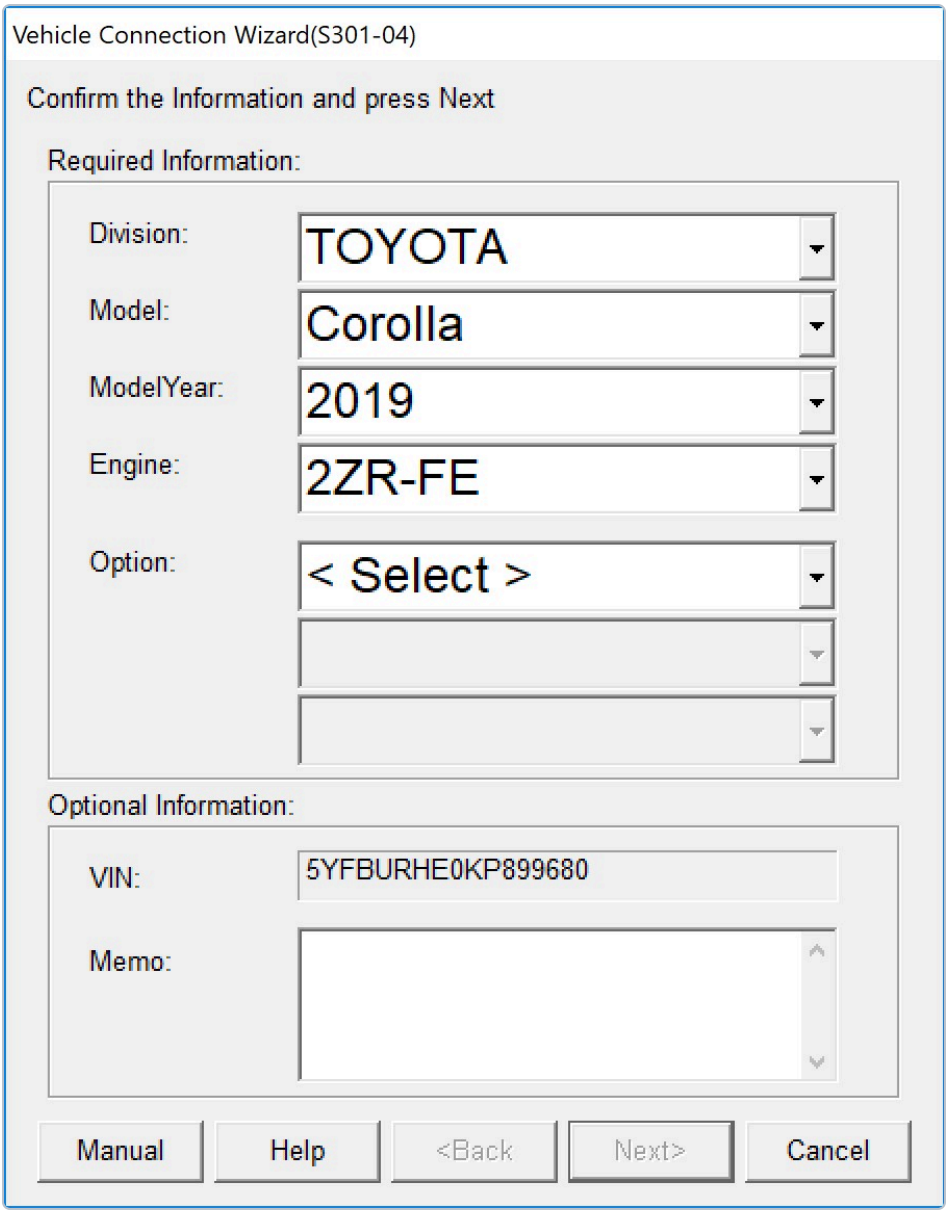


Step 3 — VIM Select.

4 Click **Connect to Vehicle** (top of the left panel).



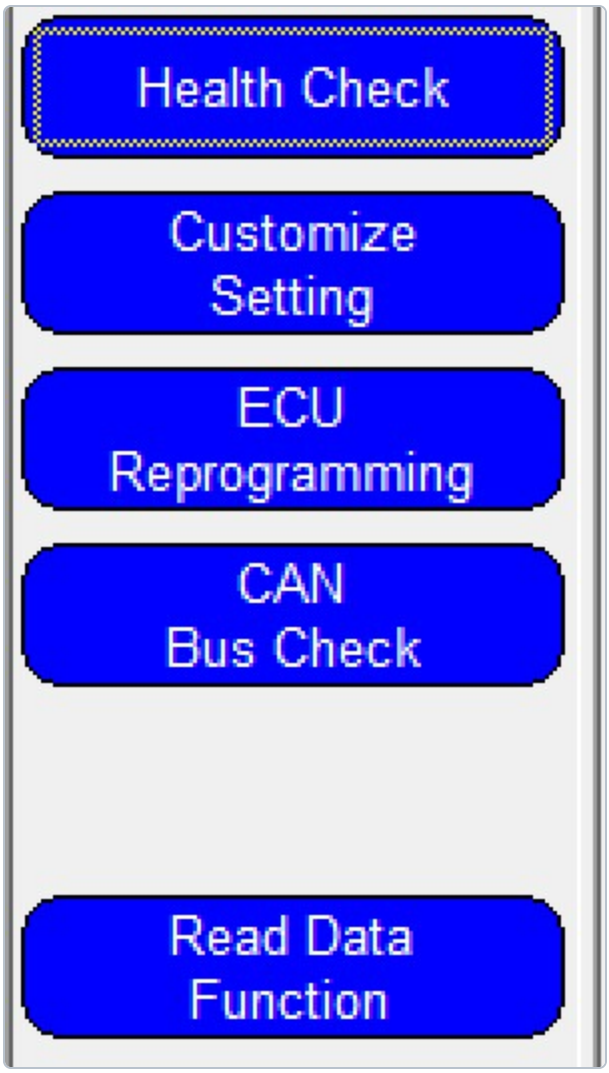
Confirm Division, Model, Year and Engine, set any options the vehicle carries, add a case note in **Memo**, then **Next**. **Capture this screen** — it is your record that the tool was on this VIN.



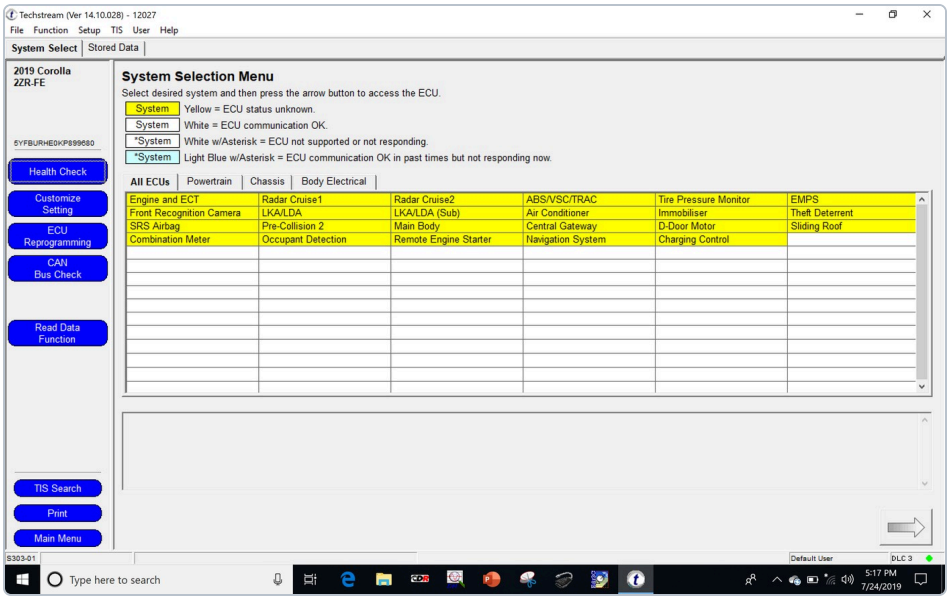
Step 4 — confirm vehicle information and VIN.

> **Connecting manually (D2M)? Type the VIN yourself.** Techstream builds the file name from the VIN — blank or wrong gives a mismatch error and a misnamed file.

5 At the System Selection Menu, run **Health Check** to bus-scan the vehicle. Save or print the report and capture the menu as your ECU inventory.



Step 5 — left panel. Health Check now; Read Data Function at step 7.



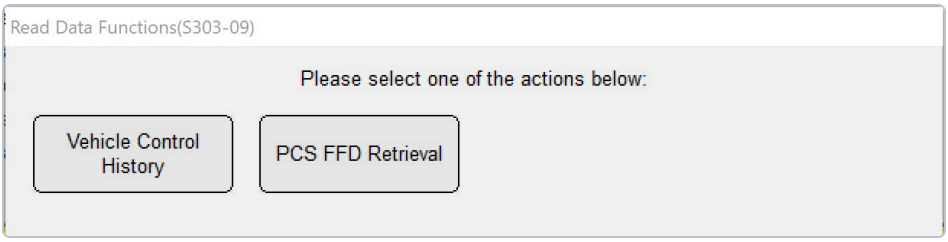
The full menu — yellow means status unknown, white means the ECU answered. Pinch to zoom.

6 Open **SRS Airbag → Trouble Codes**. Save with the disk icon and capture the current, pending and history codes. Then **Data List** — save and capture that too.

Code	Description
B1610	Front Airbag Sensor (RH)
B1615	Front Airbag Sensor (LH)
B1620	Side Airbag Sensor Assembly (RH)
B1625	Side Airbag Sensor Assembly (LH)
B1635	Curtain Shield Airbag Sensor (LH)
B1650	Occupant Classification System Malfunction
B1656	Seat Belt Buckle Switch (LH)
B1660	P Seat Airbag Active Mode Indicator

Step 6 — diagnostic codes.

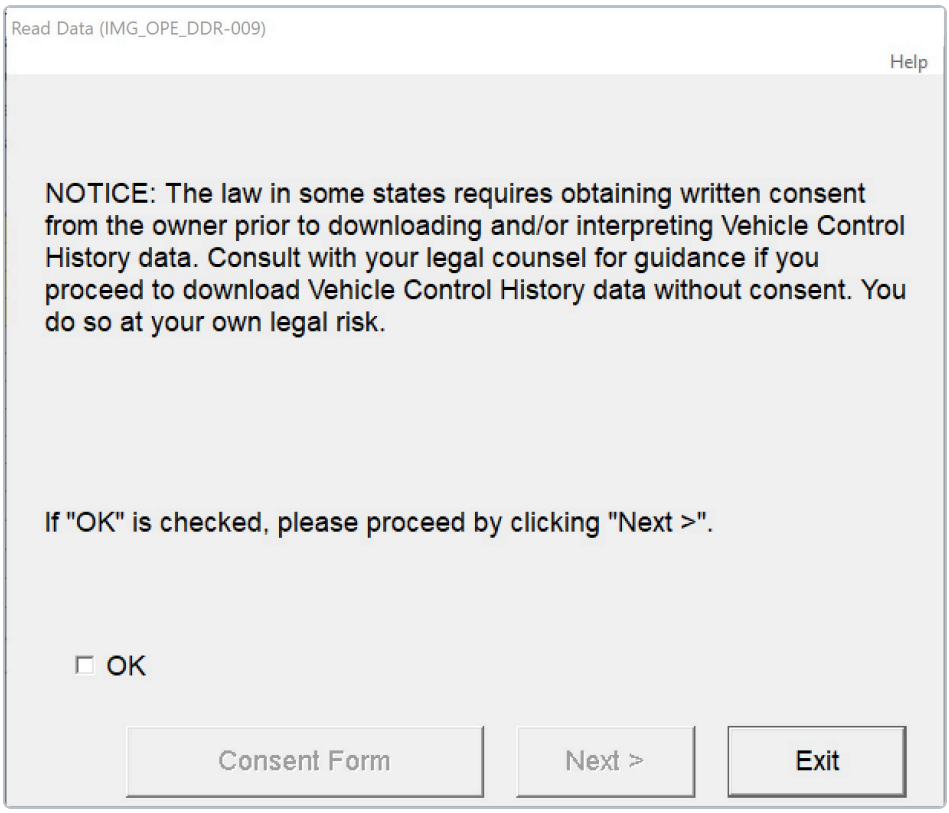
7 Back on the **System Select** tab, click **Read Data Function**, then choose **PCS FFD Retrieval**.



Step 7 — choose PCS FFD Retrieval.

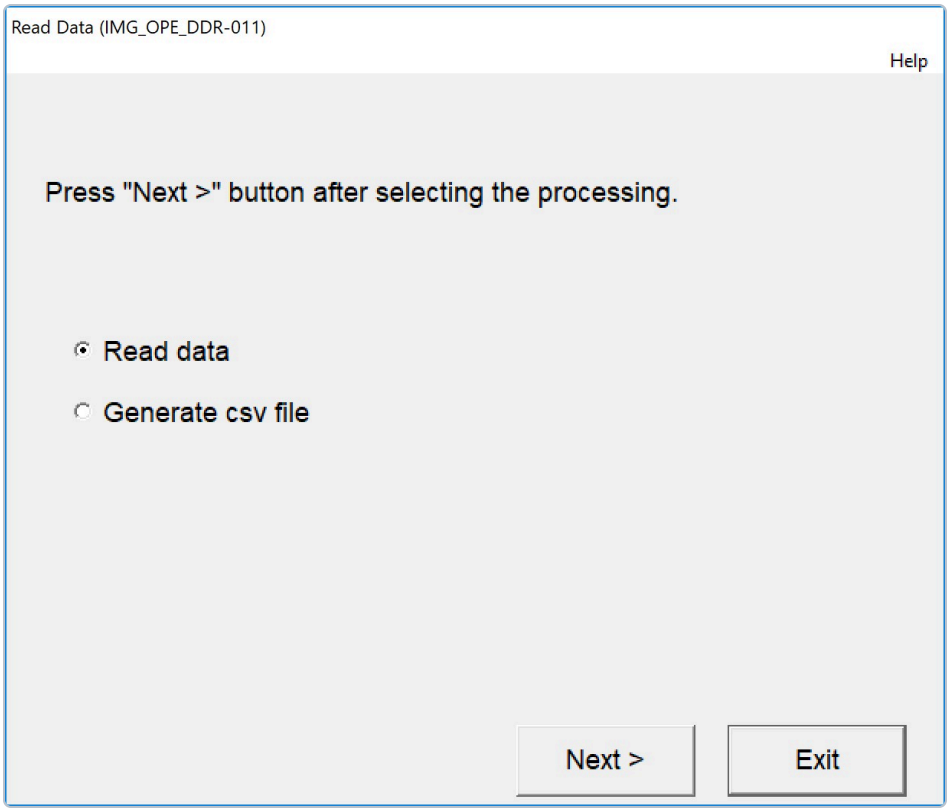
> **Not the Vehicle Control History button.** That path gets VCH only. PCS FFD Retrieval gets the VCH **and** the camera images.

8 Read the legal notice, **tick OK**, then **Next**. Capture the screen.



Step 8 — Next stays greyed out until OK is ticked.

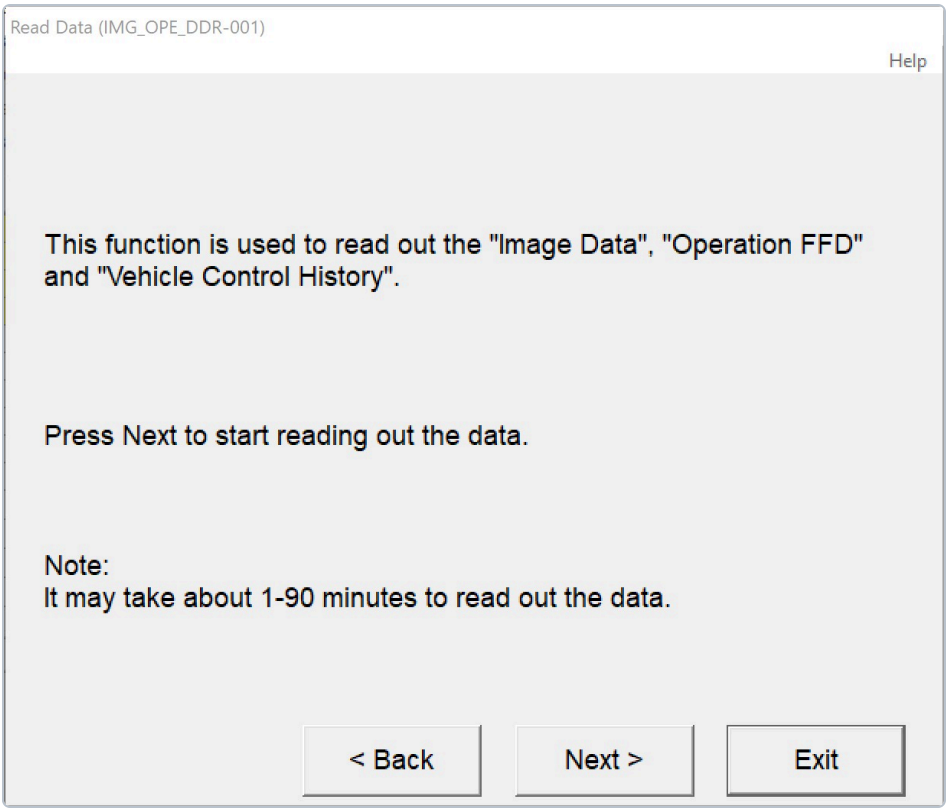
9 Select **Read data**, then **Next**.



Step 9 — choose Read data.

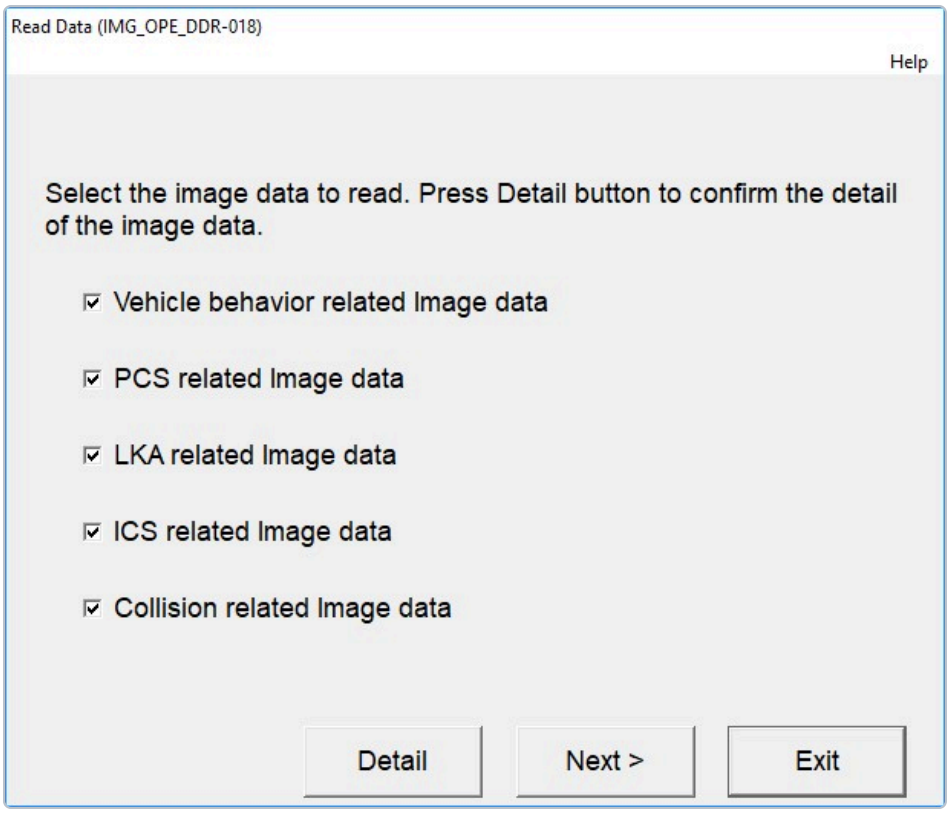
> **Not "Generate csv file".** It does not retrieve the image data. CSV output comes later, from the saved file.

10 Techstream confirms it will read out Image Data, Operation FFD and Vehicle Control History, and warns the read may take **1–90 minutes**. Confirm your power will last, then **Next**.



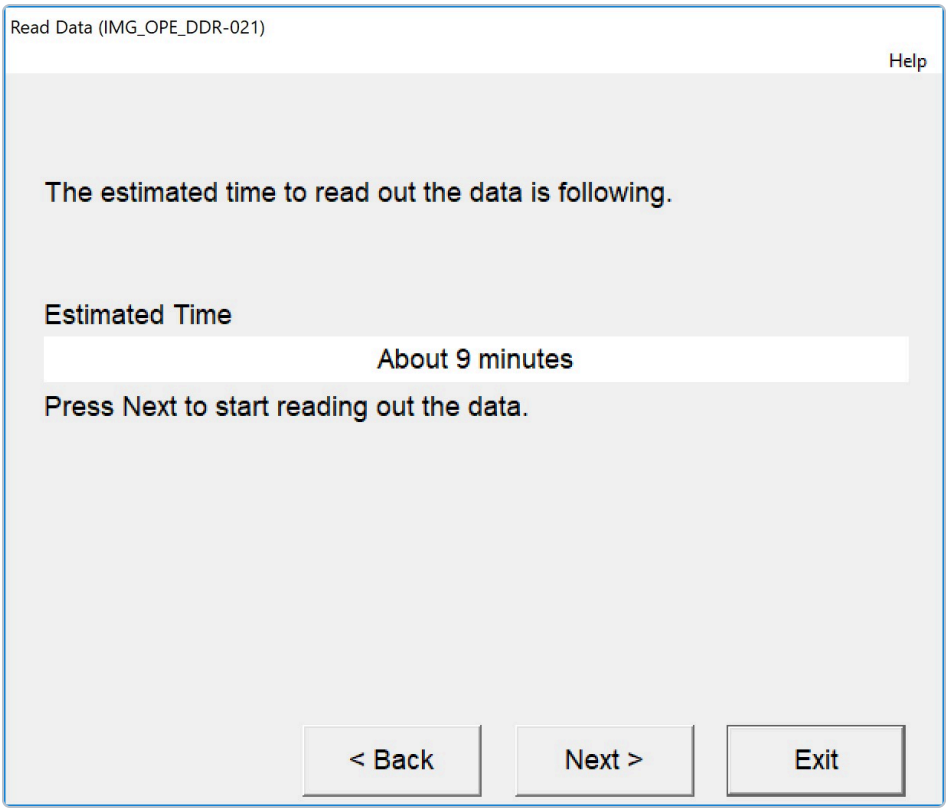
Step 10 — read-out confirmation.

11 Select the image data to read and **check every box offered** — five categories on TSS 2.0, one on TSS 1.0. Capture the screen, then **Next**.



Step 11 — TSS 2.0 selection. TSS 1.0 offers only *PCS related Image data*.

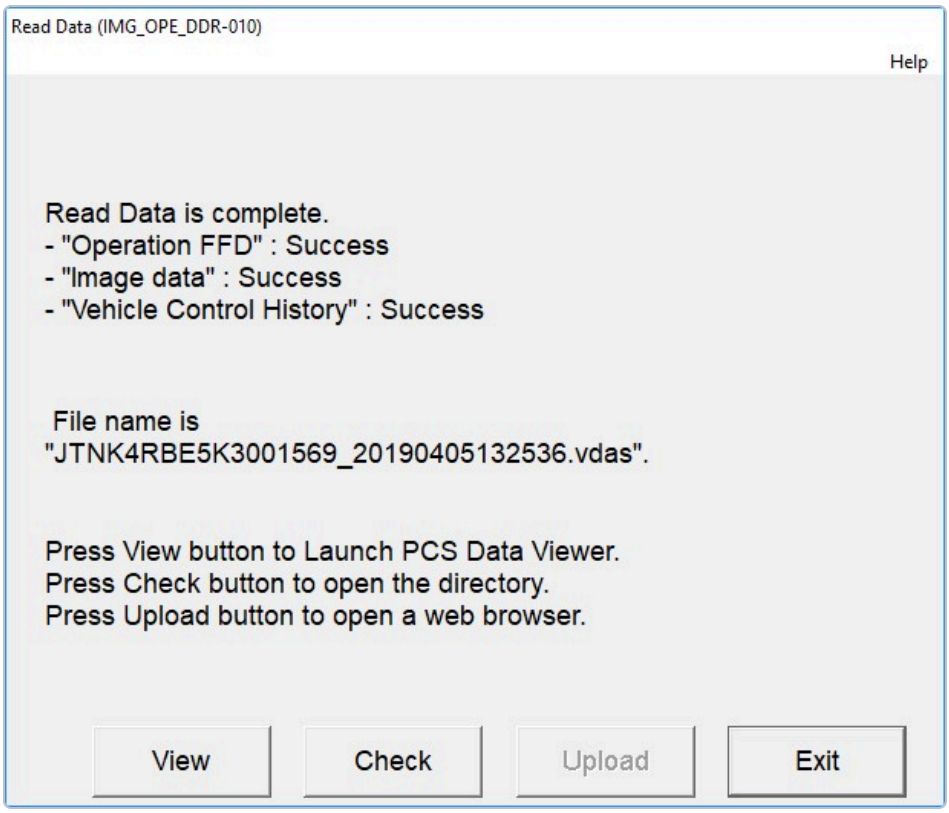
12 Check the estimated read time against your power and available time, then **Next** to start. Do not disturb the laptop or the connection while it runs.



Step 12 — estimated read time.

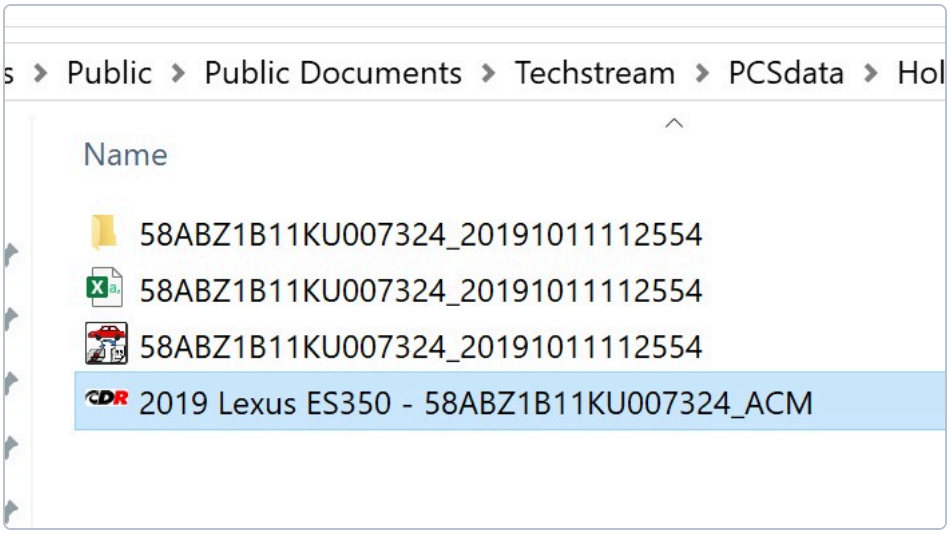
13 **Capture the completion screen — the most important capture of the retrieval.** It reports all three data sets and names the file created.

`Image data : N/A` means no images were stored. That is a finding, not a failure.



Step 13 — file name is `VIN_YYYYMMDDHHMMSS.vdas`.

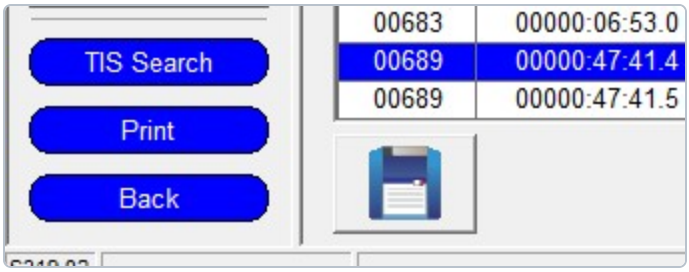
14 Click **Check**. Explorer opens at the save folder — by default `C:\Users\Public\Public Documents\ Techstream\PCSdata\`. Confirm the `.vdas` file is there and note the path.



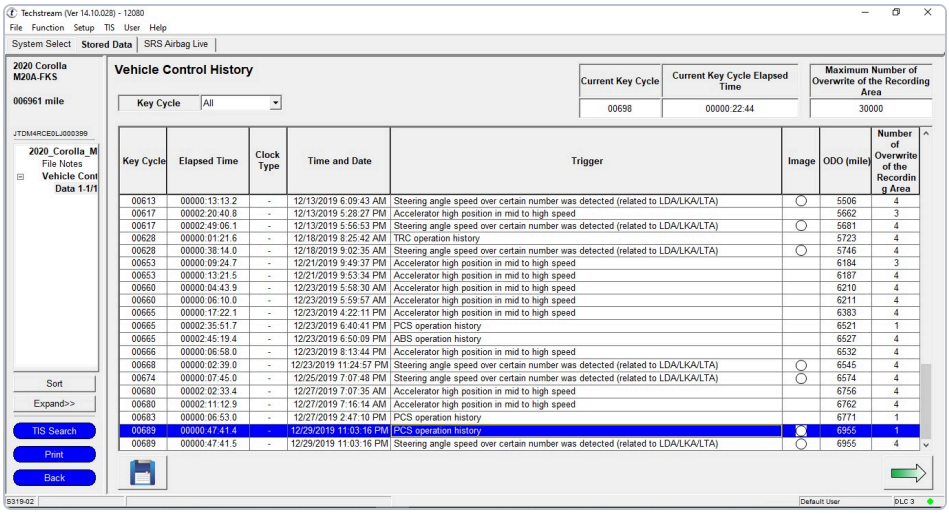
Step 14 — the retrieval file on disk.

15 Still on scene, open the **Stored Data** tab and review the event list — key cycle, elapsed time,

date and time, trigger, odometer, overwrite count. **A circle in the Image column marks an event with camera images.** Note the key cycles that matter, then export the list with the disk icon.

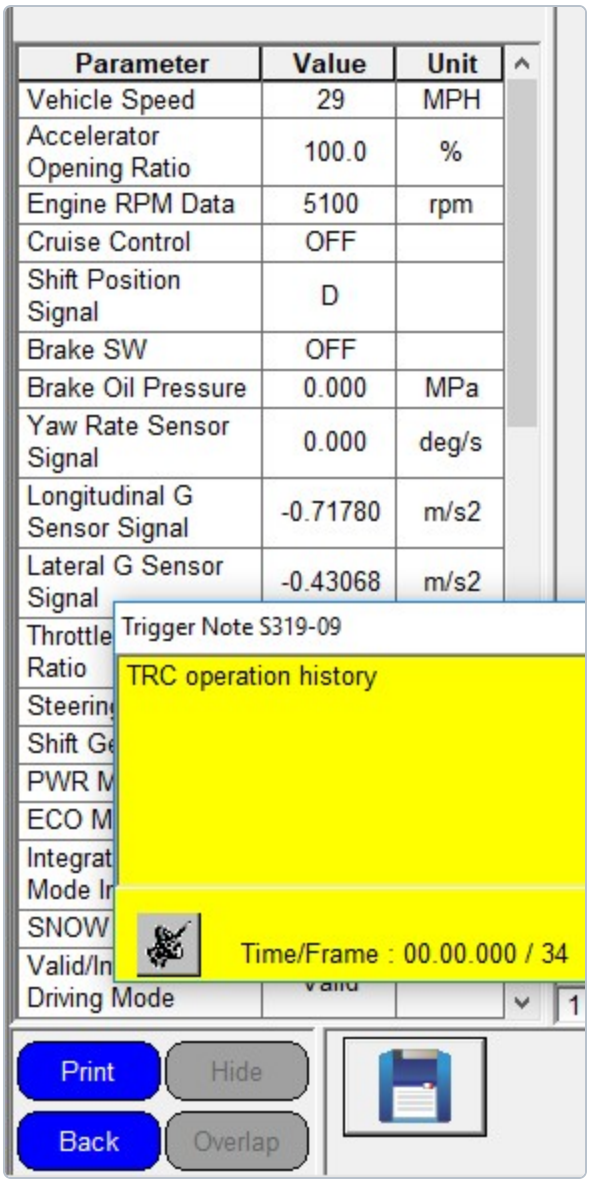


Step 15 — the disk icon, below the list on the left.



The full event list. Pinch to zoom.

16 Open each relevant event to see its parameters and trigger note, and export it with the **disk icon**.



Step 16 — event parameters, trigger note, and the disk icon below.

> **The Excel export leaves the camera images behind.** Images come out only through the PCS Data Viewer output, done later from the `.vdas` file — and only while the subscription is still active.

17 **Copy the `.vdas` file and every screen capture to external media.** Open the copy and check its size. Work the checklist, then exit Techstream, disconnect the VIM and switch the ignition off.

Before you leave

Every item below should be in hand. If one is not applicable, write down *why* rather than leaving it blank.

1. Retrieval file `VIN_…vdas`

Where: `C:\Users\Public\Public Documents\Techstream\PCSdata\`
How: copy to external media — this is the evidence

2. Read Data complete summary

Where: Read Data (IMG_OPE_DDR-010)
How: screen capture — status of all three data sets plus the file name

3. Vehicle Control History event list

Where: Stored Data → Vehicle Control History
How: export to Excel (disk icon) + screen capture

4. Individual trigger events, each one relevant

Where: event list → event → disk icon
How: export to Excel + screen capture

5. Software version & subscription expiration

Where: main screen at launch · How: screen capture

6. Interface (VIM) selection

Where: Setup → VIM Select · How: screen capture

7. Vehicle identification and VIN

Where: Vehicle Connection Wizard · How: screen capture

8. ECU inventory

Where: System Select tab · How: screen capture

9. Health Check report

Where: System Select → Health Check · How: save / print to PDF

10. SRS Airbag trouble codes

Where: SRS Airbag → Trouble Codes · How: save (disk icon) + screen capture

11. SRS Airbag data list

Where: SRS Airbag → Data List · How: save (disk icon) + screen capture

12. Consent notice as acknowledged

Where: Read Data (IMG_OPE_DDR-009) · How: screen capture

13. Image categories requested

Where: image selection screen · How: screen capture

14. Read-out estimated time

Where: Read Data (IMG_OPE_DDR-021) · How: screen capture

15. Scene photographs and clock note

Where: vehicle, VIN plate, odometer, DLC · How: camera / notes

Next, off the vehicle: load the `.vdas` file into PCS Data Viewer and run **File → Output PCS Data** for the CSV, image and PDF output. Do this **before the TIS subscription expires** — once it does, the `.vdas` file can no longer be opened. Those steps are in the full *Toyota Techstream Imaging Guide*.